

Research & Documentation

1. Project Overview

StoryCast is a three-page accessible microsite that showcases African art and artists from across the continent. The project was designed to make visual art like paintings, sculptures, silk collages, textile work, and documentary film that is fully accessible to every visitor. Every artwork on the site has a *<figcaption>* with a written description, every artist page includes an extended image description panel, and all audio and video media is accompanied by full transcripts and captions.

The site was built without any CSS or JavaScript frameworks, using only semantic HTML5, Sass, and vanilla JavaScript.

2. Information Architecture

Sitemap

```
StoryCast – African Art (Home – index.html)
|
|— Artist: El Anatsui (story/el-anatsui.html)
|   Sculpture & Installation – Ghana · Nigeria
|   Audio interview · Gallery · Extended image descriptions
|
|— Artist: Wangechi Mutu (story/wangechi-mutu.html)
|   Collage & Sculpture – Kenya · USA
|   Audio interview · Gallery · Extended image descriptions
|
|— Artist: Billie Zangewa (story/billie-zangewa.html)
|   Silk Collage – Malawi · South Africa
|   Audio interview · Gallery · Full transcript
|
|— Documentary: Women Remaking Kigali's Art Scene (story/african-art-
documentary.html)
|   Video documentary – Rwanda · East Africa
|   5 min 32 sec · Closed captions · Full transcript
|
|— About & Access (about.html)
|   Mission, accessibility commitment, team, how to engage
```

Page purposes

- *Home*: introduces the platform, featured artist, artist card grid, newsletter

- *Artist pages*: audio interview, artwork gallery, transcript, related artists sidebar
- *About & Access*: mission, accessibility features, team

Design Decisions

Color	Hex	Contrast
Body text	#F5F0E8	14.8:1
Links	#C4522A	4.9:1
Secondary text	#A89880	5.2:1
Gold	#D4A843	7.3:1

Fonts: Cormorant Garamond (headings), DM Sans (body), DM Mono (labels/metadata)

Layout: CSS Grid for page structure, Flexbox for components, container query on art cards (switches vertical → horizontal at 480px)

Accessibility

- Skip link on every page
- Every artwork in `<figure>` with `<figcaption>` describing medium and visual content
- Extended image description panels on all artist pages
- Audio interviews have full timed transcripts
- Video documentary has WebVTT captions via `<track>` element
- `aria-expanded`, `aria-current`, `aria-label` used throughout
- Visible focus ring (`:focus-visible`) on all interactive elements
- `prefers-reduced-motion` disables animations

Sass Structure

```
sass/
├─ main.scss
├─ partials/
│   ├── _colors.scss
│   ├── _typography.scss
│   ├── _spacing.scss
│   ├── _reset.scss
│   └─ _components.scss
```

Running Locally :

python -m http.server 5500

To recompile Sass: `sass --watch sass/main.scss css/main.css`

Github Link: <https://github.com/capitale1/storyCast.git>

High-fidelity mockups:

<https://www.figma.com/design/GQdrCvnIffY5HrmjxdB5TQ/Untitled?t=Erd1enofUGVcjyfk-0>

Figma sitemap:

<https://www.figma.com/board/bkQNrM8YmWM21wYGNwCYou/StoryCast?node-id=0-1&p=f&t=Hw3JdkXTGmOMa8k5-0>